

JUDY

Written by

Lorenzo Marco Besana

FADE IN:

INT. DINER - NIGHT

The second hand of the clock reaches the twelve and the clock above the counter strikes midnight.

CAMERA PANS on the OLD MAN working the counter.

OLD MAN

Can I get you anything else?

CAMERA SPINS to find LEWIS (mid 20's), sitting alone at a booth in front of him. He is behind his laptop. He has his jacket and his backpack in a chair in front of him.

Lewis looks up, taken aback from his thoughts.

LEWIS

No, thanks. I'm fine for now.

Lewis takes his eyes above the old man, to the clock.

Lewis rubs his eyes.

LEWIS

Jesus.

Lewis stands up and puts on his jacket from the chair in front of him.

He closes his laptop and turns to the old man.

LEWIS

Actually, I'm going to go for a smoke, could you pour me a cup of coffee?

OLD MAN

Sure.

Lewis exits the diner.

EXT. DINER - CONTINUOUS

Lewis leans against the diner's window and takes a cigarette out of his pocket.

He lights it as he observes the street ahead of him.

It's late. It's empty. It's quiet. The diner neon sign flickers.

He takes his phone out of his pocket. No new messages.

GIRL
Can I borrow one?

She is RACHEL (dark hair, mid 20's). She is dressed as a waitress.

LEWIS
Sorry what?

RACHEL
A cigarette. Can I borrow one?

LEWIS
Oh yeah. Of course.

Lewis takes the cigarettes out of his pocket, but drops the pack as he hands them to her.

LEWIS
Fuck.

RACHEL
I got it.

Rachel reaches down and grabs the pack. She takes one out and carefully gives the pack back to Lewis.

RACHEL
Do you have a lighter as well?

LEWIS
I do.

Lewis reaches for his pocket and takes out his lighter. He doesn't even have the time to hand it to Rachel, that she basically SNATCHES it from his hand.

Lewis looks at her confused.

RACHEL
So you don't drop it, you know?

Lewis furrows his brows and tilts his head.

Rachel smiles at him, tenderly.

RACHEL
I'm kidding.

Lewis smiles back.

She lights her cigarette, eying him from top to bottom.

RACHEL
 (throwing him his
 lighter)
 What's your name?

LEWIS
 (catching it)
 Lewis.

RACHEL
 Rachel.

LEWIS
 Nice to meet you, Rachel.

RACHEL
 Likewise, Lewis.

Lewis' cigarette comes to an end.

RACHEL
 Have another one. I don't like to
 smoke alone.

Lewis scratches his eyebrow. Looks back at his closed
 laptop, then Rachel.

LEWIS
 Sure. How much damage can one more
 make?

RACHEL
 That's what I'm saying.

Lewis pulls up one more cigarette and lights it.

He just now notices her outfit.

LEWIS
 Are you coming off work?

RACHEL
 Fancy dress party.

LEWIS
 What?

RACHEL
 Costume party.

LEWIS
 Are you British?

RACHEL

Yes.

LEWIS

You don't have the accent.

RACHEL

Because I'm not British.

LEWIS

Sorry. What?

She chuckles. He shakes his head, amused.

RACHEL

I'm coming off work, yes. I work at Harvest, couple of blocks down the road.

LEWIS

Really?

RACHEL

Yeah. Why?

LEWIS

A friend of mine used to work there.

RACHEL

No way, who?

LEWIS

Kelvin?

RACHEL

Kelvin?

LEWIS

Yeah, do you know him?

RACHEL

Nah. I just started today.

Lewis laughs and throws his cigarette to the ground, shaking his head.

LEWIS

You are a bit annoying, you know?

RACHEL

Gee, no one has ever told me that.

Lewis shakes his head again, looking straight at her.

RACHEL

What?

LEWIS

I don't know. You are hard to read.

She finishes her cigarette and smiles at him.

RACHEL

Thanks.

As she throws the cigarette to the ground A MAN walks out of the diner, almost bumping into Lewis.

Rachel looks into the diner.

RACHEL

Are you going to stay here all night?

LEWIS

I don't know about all night, but yeah, I'll stay here for a while.

RACHEL

Do you want to come to a party?

LEWIS

A fancy dress party?

RACHEL

A normal party.

LEWIS

I can't.

RACHEL

Why?

He gestures into the diner.

LEWIS

I have stuff to do.

She looks back into the diner, then at him.

RACHEL

It can wait.

LEWIS

It can't.

Rachel nods to the diner.

RACHEL
Get your stuff, let's go.

Lewis considers for a second.

LEWIS
This is a bad idea.

RACHEL
It's a great idea.

LEWIS
I'm really dumb.

Lewis heads inside.

WE STAY ON RACHEL as Lewis collects his stuff and pays.

Rachel cheerfully whistles around until Lewis comes out holding a paper cup in his hand.

RACHEL
Booze?

LEWIS
Coffee, he had poured it already.

RACHEL
Can I have a sip?

LEWIS
Have as much as you want.

Lewis hands him the cup of which she takes a very large sip, leaving about half for Lewis.

RACHEL
Very nice coffee! And hot!

LEWIS
It's terrible coffee.

RACHEL
Shut up.

LEWIS
Sure.
(a beat)
Sooo where is this party?

RACHEL
It's close, but we have a stop to make first.

LEWIS

Where?

She gestures at her clothes.

LEWIS

Elaborate.

RACHEL

These are my work clothes. I am- We are going to a party. I have to change out of my work clothes, Lewis. But it's fine, I live right there.

She points across the street a bit down the road.

LEWIS

That's a nice location.

RACHEL

It is.

LEWIS

Crazy rent?

RACHEL

I don't know. My husband owns the place.

Lewis almost chokes on his coffee.

RACHEL

It's not my "husband" husband. It's a long story. We are not together. He doesn't live with me. He just lets me stay there for free. Me and my roommate. She should still be up, I think you'll like her.

LEWIS

Am I supposed to come up?

RACHEL

What the fuck are you going to do otherwise? Stay here?

LEWIS

Yes?

RACHEL

Don't be silly. Come on.

Rachel heads for the house.

LEWIS
I guess we are doing these.

EXT. STREET - CONTINUOUS

Lewis mimics a run to cross the street and reaches Rachel on the other side.

They start walking down the street, passing a row of piled-up bikes.

RACHEL
That's my bike.

LEWIS
Which one?

She points.

RACHEL
The pink one.

Between the never-ending mass of black and grey bikes, A PINK BIKE stands out, untouched, unbothered, its basket held by A WHITE BOW.

They resume walking

LEWIS
It's pretty.

RACHEL
It's Judy.

LEWIS
What?

RACHEL
It's her name. My roommate made it for me.

LEWIS
She built it?

RACHEL
Yeah.

LEWIS
Really?

RACHEL
Of course not. Jesus. She just painted it over. It's like her boyfriend's business.

LEWIS
He paints bikes?

RACHEL
No he steals them, then she paints them and he sells them.

LEWIS
So her boyfriend is a thief.

RACHEL
That's a strong word.

LEWIS
I'm not judging.

RACHEL
Why would you?

LEWIS
Why bother and paint them?

RACHEL
So the owners don't recognize them if they see them.

LEWIS
What are the chances you are gonna randomly see your own stolen bike in this city?

RACHEL
Very big.

LEWIS
Very big?

RACHEL
(mimicking Trump)
Huge chances. Some even say the biggest chances ever.

He laughs.

LEWIS
You are something else.

RACHEL
That's the third thing I am, don't give me anymore.

LEWIS
What do you mean?

RACHEL

You said I'm annoying, that I'm hard to read and that I'm something else. You are fishing around.

LEWIS

Of course I'm fishing around, I don't know you.

RACHEL

I don't know you either but I don't need to fish around.

LEWIS

Oh yeah? What am I then?

RACHEL

I'm not telling you, what the fuck?

LEWIS

Why not?

RACHEL

I'm not that rude.

LEWIS

Sorry?

RACHEL

I'm kidding.

Rachel stops, he follows.

EXT. RACHEL'S BUILDING - CONTINUOUS

They stop in front of a narrow red metal door.

There is a sign that says "FRACASSO" over the storefront next door.

LEWIS

(as she puts in the key)
What's "Frah-ka-soh"?

RACHEL

Jesus you are such a Yankee. It's fracasso, it's Italian for...

She turns to him, smiles cunningly.

LEWIS

For?

Suddenly Rachel bangs her fist against the metal door.

Lewis drops his cup with the coffee.

LEWIS
What the fuck are you doing?

RACHEL
Fracasso.

A grouchy man appears at a window in the opposing building.

MAN
What is this fracasso?!

RACHEL
Sorry, Stew. My fault.

STEW
The kids are sleeping, it's late.

RACHEL
I know, Stew. It's my fault.

Dogs start barking inside Stew's apartment.

RACHEL
(to Lewis)
Fuck, let's go in. Quick.

STEW (O.C.)
Baby come on go back to sleep.

RACHEL
Get in.

Rachel grabs Lewis' arm and drags him inside, closing the door behind him.

INT. RACHEL'S BUILDING - CONTINUOUS

They stand there in the dark, then Rachel claps her hand and light it is.

Lewis looks at the dutch staircase in front of them, then realizes how small the hall is and how close to each other they are standing.

He tries to unnoticeably move, and she notices, but doesn't say anything.

RACHEL
Follow me.

Rachel leads the way up the steep dutch staircase and Lewis tries to keep up, fatigued by his smoking habits.

LEWIS

You shouldn't have made me smoke
two cigarettes.

RACHEL

I didn't make you do shit.

They finally reach the door at the top of the stairs.

Rachel pushes it open and they enter.

INT. RACHEL'S APARTMENT - CONTINUOUS

The door opens on a spacious loft. Right in front of it, it's the living room, with the couches and the tv. On the door's right there's a blue door and then a modern kitchen, before a corner which leads to another bedroom.

The whole place looks like it's the fruit of a designer's mind. Nothing is out of place, everything is in tune, besides... What's playing on tv.

On one of the couches sits LEXI (mid 20's), Rachel's roommate, she doesn't acknowledge them as they enter as she is fully focused on the tape of a WATER BIRTH she is watching.

RACHEL

Hey Lexi. This is Lewis.

LEWIS

Hi.

She just lift a hand without turning to them.

RACHEL

Let's go in my room.

She points to the door next to the entrance. As Lewis twists the handle a woman SCREAMS on tv.

Rachel and Lewis enter the room.

INT. RACHEL'S ROOM - CONTINUOUS

The room is tidy. The bed is right under a big window over the street and it has blue sheets. There's a desk in front of it with various make up items on it, next to it is a small library, above which hangs the painting of a blowing candle. On the opposite side is the wardrobe and a coatrack, next to which, in a corner, there are a couple of empty rosé bottles.

RACHEL
I wish I was a candle, so that I
could last forever, as long as no
one burns me.

LEWIS
Who is that from?

RACHEL
Me.

Lewis drops his backpack which doesn't thump.

LEWIS
What the fuck?

He drops to his knees to open his backpack which is EMPTY.

LEWIS
Where the fuck is it?

RACHEL
What?

LEWIS
My laptop.

RACHEL
I don't know.

LEWIS
Did I fucking leave it there?

RACHEL
How would I know?

LEWIS
Fuck. Fuck. Fuck.

Lewis quickly stands up and as he does his phone drops out
of his pocket.

He RUNS out of the apartment. As he exits the woman on
screen SCREAMS again.

EXT. STREET - CONTINUOUS

Lewis sprints out of the building.

As he turns, a bum holding a wine bottle bumps into him.

BUM
Yo!

LEWIS

Sorry!

BUM

This motherfuckers will get what
they deserve one day.

Mark picks up his pace as he heads for the diner as fast as
he possibly can.

EXT. DINER - CONTINUOUS

Lewis speed walks into the diner.

INT. DINER - CONTINUOUS

The door chimes. Lewis enters.

He heads for the table he was sitting at, but the laptop is
not there.

He goes to the counter and presses on the bell.

No one answers. He turns to the diner to see AN OLD WOMAN
sitting alone in a corner, a plate of raw onions in front
her. She stares at him, emotionless.

LEWIS

Sorry, lady, have you seen anyone
come in and take a laptop from that
table?

She shakes her head without taking her eyes way from him.

KID

Can I help you?

The Old Man is gone and now, behind the counter, there's a
young kid, no older than eighteen.

LEWIS

Have you taken a laptop from that
table?

KID

I just clocked in dude.

LEWIS

Fuck.

(a beat)

Do you have a lost and found?

KID

Yes.

LEWIS

Can-

Before he can answer the kid has already gone for the back.
Lewis looks around nervously, biting his nails.

ONION LADY

You shouldn't do that.

LEWIS

What?

KID

There it is.

The kid drops a plastic grey tray on the counter. Inside of it there are a small purple teddy bear, a flip phone and a pin that says "Making Love in 2002".

LEWIS

Are you sure this is it?

KID

This is it.

LEWIS

Fuck.

KID

What are you looking for dude?

LEWIS

I think I left my laptop here.

KID

Your laptop?

LEWIS

Yeah.

KID

Shiii. How do you forget your laptop.

LEWIS

I don't know.

The kid slaps the counter and starts laughing.

KID

Bro is down bad.

LEWIS

Can you help me or not?

The kid takes a moment to calm down.

KID

Sorry. Sorry. I get it. Last night I was wasted and forgot my hoodie over on the Westside. I got beef down there.

LEWIS

This is very important. Can you help me or not?

KID

Maybe Orvad took it. The other guy. To keep it safe. I can give you his number.

LEWIS

Yes. Great. Probably he did.

Lewis taps his pocket. And taps them. And taps them. His phone is not there.

LEWIS

I can't believe this.

KID

If you left it here you'll find dude don't worry.

LEWIS

I lost my phone.

KID

Are you homeless or some shit?

LEWIS

Fuck. Can you write the number down?

KID

How are you gonna call him?

LEWIS

I know where my phone is.

KID

Your bitch got it, eh?

LEWIS

Don't call women that come on. You're a child.

KID
Whatever dude. I know where my shit
is at least.

The kid takes his phone out and scribbles the phone number
on a napkin, before giving it to Lewis.

Lewis puts it in his pocket.

LEWIS
Thank you.

KID
Good luck.

Lewis heads out.

ONION LADY
(as Lewis exits)
You shouldn't do that.

EXT. STREET - CONTINUOUS

Lewis walks out and heads back to Rachel's place. As he
walks the bum he met before sees him.

BUM
Yo! Yo! Come here!

Lewis quickly eyes him and picks up his pace. The bum does
the same.

BUM
Come here! Where you going!

The bum hurries so Lewis starts sprinting.

BUM
Don't run! Wait!

Lewis reaches Rachel's door and presses the buzzer.

Just before the bum can reach him, Lewis disappears in the
building.

INT. RACHEL'S BUILDING - CONTINUOUS

Lewis hobbles up the dutch stairs and pushes the door.

INT. RACHEL'S APARTMENT - CONTINUOUS

All the light are on.

Lewis finds Lexi in the kitchen, dressed in a long green dress sipping a martini in the kitchen.

LEXI
Lewis, right?

LEWIS
(panting)
Yes.

LEXI
Are you okay?

LEWIS
I lost my laptop.

LEXI
Here?

LEWIS
I lost my phone here.

LEXI
Not in Rachel's room, right?

LEWIS
(catching his breath)
It must be there.

LEXI
Well she's gone.

LEWIS
What?

LEXI
She had a party or something.

LEWIS
Fuck.
(a beat)
Can I go in real quick?

LEXI
She locks her room. A bit fucked up
if you ask me.

Lewis looks around. Contemplating the situation.

LEXI
Do you want a drink?

LEWIS
I want my laptop.

LEXI
Well I can only get you a drink.

LEWIS
Can I borrow your phone?

LEXI
That I can do, it's on the couch.

Lewis goes to the couch to pick up Lexi's phone.

He finds it next to a magazine containing pictures of births.

He decides to ignore it.

LEWIS
What's the code?

LEXI
O. Nine. One. One.

LEWIS
Nine eleven?

LEXI
It's my father's birthday.

Lewis unlocks the phone and takes the napkin with Orvad's (the old man) number. He press the digits and puts the phone to his ear.

Lexi comes to him, holding a brand new martini.

LEXI
Picking up?

LEWIS
No.

LEXI
You should report it as stolen.

VOICEMAIL
The number you have dialed...

Lewis hangs up and puts the phone back on the couch.

LEWIS
Fuck me.

LEXI
Report it as stolen.

LEWIS
How? My phone is locked in that
room.

LEXI
Maybe.

LEWIS
Let's not.

LEXI
My boyfriend is a cop.

LEWIS
A cop?

LEXI
A cop.

LEWIS
Really?

LEXI
Yeah. Why?

He shakes his head, remembering Rachel's story about the
boyfriend's bike-stealing business.

LEWIS
Can he help somehow?

LEXI
Maybe? I don't know. He'll be here
soon though.

LEWIS
Okay good.
(a beat)
Do you mind if I sit down?

LEXI
Please. I'll join you.

Lewis falls on the couch. Lexis joins him.

LEWIS
(picking up the magazine)
Are you a gynecologist?

LEXI
I'm a painter.

LEWIS
Like. For a living?

LEXI
I don't even know what you mean by
that.

The buzzer hits, loudly.

Lexi jumps up, cheerful.

LEXI
There he is.

She hands Lewis her drink.

LEXI
Hold this.

She goes to buzz her boyfriend up.

The heavy steps of the boyfriend are heard all through the
living room.

LEWIS
A bit loud isn't it?

LEWI
You get used to it.

The door swings and enters SAM, towering with his black
boots, denim jacket and blonde hair.

Sam kisses Lexi, then notices Lewis, now standing behind
couch looking right at them. Lexi takes back her martini.

Sam demeanor rapidly shifts, from comfortable to
inquisitive.

SAM
(to Lexi)
Who's this?

LEXI
Friend of Rachel's.

SAM
What's he doing here?

LEXI
He lost his laptop.

Sam eyes sparkle. He turns to Lewis.

SAM
What's your name?

LEWIS

Lewis.

Sam steps closer and extends his hand.

SAM

Sam.

Lewis shakes his hand.

SAM

Do you have a phone on you, Lewis?

LEXI

It's in Rachel's room.

SAM

Closed?

LEXI

Yeah.

SAM

Good.

LEWIS

Good?

SAM

I mean- at least you know for sure
where that is.

LEXI

He has the number of the guy who
took it.

LEWIS

I don't know if he took it.

SAM

Can I see it?

Lewis hands him the pice of paper with the number scribbled
over.

Sam looks at the number, then at Lexi, a coy smile hinted on
his face. Lewis catches it.

LEWIS

What?

SAM

I think I know where your laptop
is.

LEWIS
Yeah? Where is it?

SAM
Don't worry about that. I'll send a
colleague of mine and I'll bring it
back to you right here.

LEWIS
No way. I'll go get it

SAM
Nah man. You need to wait here for
Rachel. I got it. Don't worry.

LEWIS
But-

SAM
(turning to Lexi)
We need to go.

Lexi downs her martini as Sam opens the door for her.

LEXI
See you, Lewis.

Lexi exits the door and Sam would follow, but Lewis rapidly
stops him.

LEWIS
Wait.

SAM
Yes?

LEWIS
When is your friend going to be
here?

SAM
I don't know man. Soon. Three
hours? Four?

LEWIS
Four hours? Can't I just go get
myself?

SAM
It's easier this way.

LEWIS
Wh- How?

SAM

Listen dude, just wait here, take a nap, I don't know. He'll be here soon. It's gonna take a second.

Sam heads out and Lewis is left to hear his heavy thumping accompanied by Lexi's light clattering.

He looks around- stunned- then let's himself go over the couch, where, for lack of better alternatives, he softly trails off.

INT. RACHEL'S APARTMENT - LATER

A loud thump wakes Lewis from his sleep.

He looks around, confused. It takes him a moment to realize where he is.

He stands up and walks to the windows on the other side of the apartment. It's still the middle of night. He didn't sleep for long, or maybe he did. Who knows.

He looks down at the street. It's completely empty. The neon sign of the diner the only sign of life.

He turns back to the kitchen, where he opens a cupboard in search for a glass.

With the glass in his hand, he turns to the sink, where he finally notices the note Rachel left.

RACHEL (V.O.)

*I'm at Kelly's party down on 221st.
The guy forgot his phone in my
room, I closed it, but give me a
call if he comes back and I'll be
there in a sec.*

*Lewis, if it's you that are reading
this: you said you would come with
me so you better get your ass down
here.*

Lewis puts down the note and sighs.

LEWIS

What the fuck is going on?

BZZZZZ! The buzzer hits, startling Lewis.

He goes back to the window and sees downstairs a man, next to a black car, holding a bag.

MAN #1
Yo. Are you the laptop guy?

LEWIS
Yeah.

MAN #1
(holding up the bag)
I got it right here.

LEWIS
Really? That's amazing. I'm gonna
buzz you up, okay?

MAN #1
Nah. You come down.

Lewis frowns a bit.

LEWIS
Sure.

MAN #1
Do you have the 200?

LEWIS
Sorry? 200 what?

MAN #1
Dollars! Are you stupid? The money!
Do you have it?

LEWIS
What money?

MAN #1
Sam didn't tell you? It's \$100 for
the recovery and \$100 for the
delivery. Do you have it?

Lewis quickly opens his wallet. There's only one \$20 dollar
bill.

LEWIS
I have like 20 bucks.

MAN #1
Then I'm going to leave now.

LEWIS
What do you mean you are going to
leave?

MAN #1

It's \$200. You don't have it. So
I'm going to leave now.

LEWIS

What?! What kind of cop are you
supposed to be?

The man doesn't answer. He turns back to his car, opens the
passenger side of his car and throws in the bag.

LEWIS

Wait!

The man proceeds to the driver seat and Lewis sprints out of
the apartment.

EXT. RACHEL'S BUILDING - CONTINUOUS

Lewis rushes down the dutch stairs, almost tripping on the
narrow stairs, but finally reaches the red metal door and
exits.

EXT. STREET - CONTINUOUS

Lewis comes out swinging the door, only to see the black car
bolt away in the distance.

LEWIS

FUCK!

A huge *fracasso* is suddenly heard behind him, where the red
door has swung back and is now closed shut.

A dog starts barking again in Stew's apartment.

Lewis looks around, looks up at the apartment, back at the
door, at the *fracasso* bar sign, then at the light in Stew's
apartment turning on.

He picks up his pace, headed to the party, headed to Rachel.

EXT. 221 STREET - LATER

CAMERA STILL on the 221st street sign, then slowly on Lewis
under it.

The street is quiet, but there's a soft clamor coming from
the end of it. Lewis heads towards it.

As he walks the clamor turns louder, turning more and more
into techno music.

Lewis finally arrives under the building the music seems to be coming from. Strobe lights circling over the big windows at the top floor.

TWO GUYS around Lewis' age stand in front of the building's door- looking like they are waiting to be buzzed up. Something that surely seems easier said than done.

Lewis walks to the bottom of the stairs.

CHRIS

I told you we shouldn't have left.

ANDY

Bro. I needed cigarettes.

CHRIS

There's a hundred million people up there. There wasn't one person up there to bum you a cigarette?

ANDY

I don't want to be that person.

CHRIS

Jesus Christ.

LEWIS

Sorry guys.

They turn at him, confused as they had not seen him approaching at all.

LEWIS

Is this Kelly's party?

ANDY

(to Chris)

Who the fuck is Kelly?

CHRIS

It's Vera's roommate.

ANDY

Who the fuck is Vera.

CHRIS

Are you being for real, Andy?

ANDY

What?

CHRIS
She opened the door for us when we
arrived. You introduced yourself.
She is the one throwing this party.

ANDY
Ah. Good for her.

LEWIS
So it's not Kelly's party.

ANDY
No dude, sorry.

CHRIS
(to Andy)
You are so dumb.
(to Lewis)
It is. Are you also trying to get
in?

LEWIS
Yeah. Do you know if a Rachel is up
there somewhere?

Chris and Andy instantly turn to each other, complicit.

CHRIS
Why?

LEWIS
Wh- I- I forgot my phone over at
her place.

ANDY
Sure you did.

LEWIS
Am I missing something?

CHRIS
Your phone.

LEWIS
Yeah.

ANDY
Yeah.

The door buzzes open.

ANDY
We'll get you to Rachel all right.

The guys enter but Lewis hesitates.

CHRIS
What are you waiting for? Come on.

Lewis, given how he doesn't really have any other choice,
follows up the stairs.

Lewis enters and closes the door behind him.

INT. HALL - CONTINUOUS

The hall is spacious, but dirty.

Andy calls for the elevator.

5.

CHRIS
So- What do you do-

LEWIS
Lewis.

4.

CHRIS
I'm Chris.

They shake hands.

ANDY
Andy.

LEWIS
Nice to meet you, Andy.

ANDY
Nice to meet you, Lewis.

3.

CHRIS
What do you do, Lewis?

LEWIS
Like- as a job?

ANDY
Yeah.

LEWIS
I'm a history teacher.

ANDY
Really?

LEWIS
Why?

CHRIS
You are young.

2.

LEWIS
What do you do?

ANDY
We sell drugs.

CHRIS
That's one way of framing that.

ANDY
It's what we do.

CHRIS
Farmaceutical reps.

1.

LEWIS
Do you like it?

ANDY
Do you like teaching history to
little kids?

LEWIS
Who said they were little kids.

CHRIS
It's not high school, is it?

LEWIS
It's middle school.

ANDY
Precisely.

DING. The elevator lands.

The elevator opens on a guy with a girl on his shoulders. We
don't see her head as it exceeds the frame of the entrance.

The guy proceed out as the girls bends to somehow don't get
caught in the edge.

As if nothing happened, Chris and Andy step into the elevator. Lewis observe the strange couple leave the building before stepping in himself.

ANDY
(as the elevator closes)
Are you also fucking Rachel?

The elevator closes and takes off.

CHRIS (O.C.)
"Also" is crazy.

INT. HALLWAY - MOMENTS LATER

We catch the guys back on the fifth floor. The music is muffled and loud. The doors open on Lewis on one side, Andy and Chris on the other. The silence between them the clear result of what must have been an awkward elevator ride.

They step out of the elevator.

CHRIS
It's that door at the end.

LEWIS
Yeah. I can tell.

They walk towards the door, then Chris pulls the handle and they disappear inside.

INT. KELLY'S PARTY - LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Inside it's loud, packed and smokey. The apartment opens on the living room, which has a balcony on the left, but there's no one on it.

CHRIS
CLOSE THE DOOR!

Lewis does, revealing a red door behind it.

Chris picks the handle of the red door and signals Lewis to follow him.

INT. KELLY'S PARTY - SMOKE ROOM - CONTINUOUS

They enter the red door to find themselves into sort of a chill smoke room. People sit around on couches and futons, quietly smoking. The two open windows are clearly not enough to correct the air flow.

Andy shuts the door behind them, completely shutting off the music.

Chris points at a dark haired girl smoking by herself facing one of the windows.

Lewis walks up to her and taps her shoulder, as he does, the music briefly enters the room and exits again.

The girl turns and.... She's NOT Rachel. At least not the Rachel we have met before.

Lewis turns to the guys, but they are already far gone.

RACHEL #2

Yes?

LEWIS

You are not Rachel.

RACHEL #2

Yes, I am.

LEWIS

But-

RACHEL #2

Who the fuck are you?

LEWIS

I'm Lewis. I was looking for Rachel.

RACHEL #2

Here I am.

LEWIS

I wasn't looking for you.

RACHEL #2

That's rude.

LEWIS

How is that rude?

RACHEL #2

Well you don't go up to a person just to be like "who the fuck are you?".

LEWIS

I didn't say that.

RACHEL #2

Your face did.

LEWIS

Listen, I'm sorry. I am looking for another Rachel, you have similar hair. I made a mistake. I'm going to leave you alone. Again, I'm sorry.

Lewis tries to go away, but Rachel #2 grabs his wrist.

RACHEL #2

Wait. I think I know who you are looking for.

She lets his wrist go.

LEWIS

You do?

RACHEL #2

Yeah...

(with a vague sadness)

This happened before .

LEWIS

Like- tonight?

RACHEL #2

Like- every night.

(a beat)

It's the hair, you know? But they are never looking for me. Always for her. "Oh shit, I thought you were someone else". Yeah no shit, asshole. Would it hurt to at least *PRETEND* and make a bit of conversation?

LEWIS

Shit. That must be awful.

RACHEL #2

It is.

LEWIS

These two guys brought me to you, I had no idea. I'm sorry.

RACHEL #2

What two guys?

LEWIS

Chris and...

RACHEL #2
Andy. Chris and Andy. Andy and
Chris. It's always those too.

LEWIS
You know them?

RACHEL #2
Yeah. They are my roommates.

LEWIS
Geez.

RACHEL #2
What "geez"?

LEWIS
I don't know they seem like quite
the characters.

RACHEL #2
Yeah? So what? You got a problem
with them?

LEWIS
What the fuck? Listen, I'm going to
go. Sorry to have bothered you.
Have a great night.

Lewis goes to leave the room.

RACHEL #2
(as Lewis leaves the
room, shouting)
SHE IS NOT HERE!

Lewis exits, the other smokers turn to Rachel #2.

RACHEL #2
What? She isn't.

INT. KELLY'S PARTY - LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Lewis steps into the loud living room. He looks around,
trying to spot Rachel's dark hair.

Suddenly, he sees Chris and Andy, talking to a girl in a
BLONDE BOB. They are a bit far away from him, close to the
opening to the BALCONY.

LEWIS
CHRIS! ANDY!

They can't hear him, of course.

Lewis starts heading towards them. Trying to squeeze between the crowd.

LEWIS

CHRIS!

He bumps into a guy's arm, spilling his drink.

GUY #1

Yo!

LEWIS

Sorry!

Lewis fights through the loud mass of sweaty bodies.

He pushes left, ducks right, but there doesn't seem to be a way for him to get to them. No gaps forming.

CAMERA RISES ABOVE the crowd, revealing a wall of people between him and them.

Lewis finally spots an opening. He dives into it. Chris, Andy and the girl slip away, into another room.

Lewis finally emerges from the crowd, only to not find them where they were supposed to be.

The crowd thickens around him, closing him in on the balcony's entrance door

CAMERA FALLS on Lewis.

Lewis looks around. Sighs. Exits on the balcony.

EXT. KELLY'S PARTY - BALCONY - CONTINUOUS

Lewis steps outside. A couple of pigeons fly away.

He leans on the brick guard of the balcony. Takes out a cigarette and lights it. He stares at the city ahead from above, it's quiet and beautiful.

He takes a deep drag out of his cigarette.

As he exhales, he hears the door opening behind him.

KELLY

You can't smoke here.

He turns around, to find KELLY (mid 20's, long, dyed grey hair)

LEWIS
Sorry?

KELLY
You can't smoke here.

LEWIS
I'm outside.

KELLY
There's a whole room for smoking.

LEWIS
I know.

KELLY
Then why are you not smoking there?

LEWIS
It's- it's complicated. I needed a
bit of air.

KELLY
I understand that- but I don't want
people on my balcony.

LEWIS
Wait- are you throwing the party?

KELLY
Yeah.

LEWIS
Are you Kelly?

KELLY
Yeah.

LEWIS
No way.

KELLY
Do we know each other?

LEWIS
I know Rachel.

KELLY
Which one?

LEWIS
Not Chris and Andy Rachel, the
other one.

Kelly changes her whole demeanor, becomes way more relaxed and open.

KELLY
Are you Lewis?

LEWIS
Yeah.

KELLY
Oh shit. I didn't think you would actually come. Are you looking for her or something?

LEWIS
I really am.

KELLY
I see.
(a beat)
She's in the other room. Come with me.

She opens the door and gestures Lewis to follow her.

He does.

INT. KELLY'S PARTY - LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

It has gotten even more crowded. As Lewis closes the door, he can see Kelly slipping within the cracks in the crowd.

He HURRIES to follow. She is just much faster.

He squishes through, tracking her grey hair like a hound.

How big is this room?

He looks up and sees the door to the other room. Her mane of hair reducing faster and faster to a bunch of locks, swerving between anonymous faces.

But the door is there. She turns to him.

KELLY
(inaudible)
Come!

She passes through the door. He loses her.

Someone grabs his hand from behind.

He turns instinctively.

There she is.

Rachel #2.

LEWIS

What?!

Rachel #2 tries to drag him away by his hand, but he stands his ground.

RACHEL #2

(mouthed)

Please.

Lewis gives in.

She drags him outside the crowd.

They reach the apartment door.

RACHEL #2

Let's talk outside, please.

LEWIS

Sure. Why not.

RACHEL #2

It's gonna take a sec, I swear.

They step outside.

INT. HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

Lewis closes the door behind him. Rachel #2 is by his side with a radiant smile painted on his face.

RACHEL #2

I need your help.

LEWIS

Are you kidding me?

RACHEL #2

Why?

LEWIS

I was literally going to Rachel.
The Rachel I need, and you
physically stopped me.

RACHEL #2

She is not here.

LEWIS
Yes she is.

RACHEL #2
Source?

LEWIS
Kelly. I was following her to her.

RACHEL #2
Kelly is full of shit.

LEWIS
Why would she lie to me?

RACHEL #2
Why would I lie to you?

LEWIS
That's-

RACHEL #2
Exactly.

LEWIS
How do you know she is not here?

RACHEL #2
I say her leave with my own eyes.

LEWIS
When?

RACHEL #2
Before you ever got here.

LEWIS
That doesn't make any sese.

RACHEL #2
I can prove it to you.

LEWIS
Yeah?

RACHEL #2
Yeah.

LEWIS
How?

RACHEL #2
I know where she went.

LEWIS
Which is where?

RACHEL #2
Where I'm going. But I need your help.

LEWIS
My help with what?

RACHEL #2
There's this guy-

LEWIS
Jesus.

RACHEL #2
What? Why do you have to be such a prick I'm trying to help you here.

LEWIS
I don't trust you, Rachel.

RACHEL #2
Well- that's fucked up. You can stay then and wiggle through that mess to not find her.

Rachel #2 pats his shoulder, condescendingly, then turns to the elevator.

She takes a couple of steps, when-

LEWIS
Wait.

She stops.

LEWIS
What is it with this guy?

Rachel #2 turns to him, knowing she got him right where she wants him.

